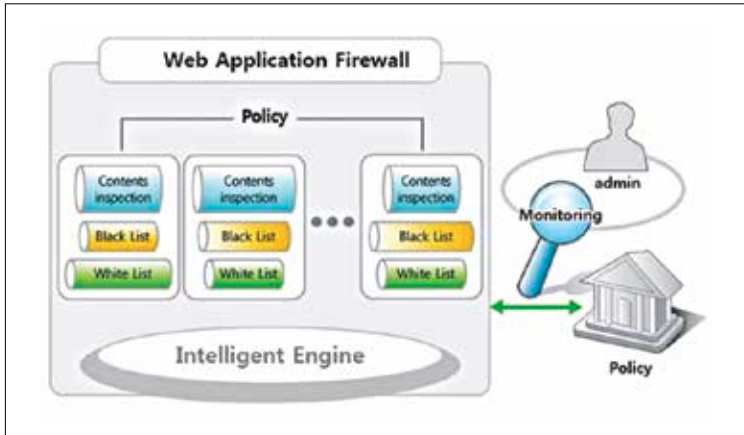


etc. because we are more aware of the possibility of an attack on those devices. What we often overlook is the fact that our website is also stored on a physical server somewhere, be it a dedicated server that you have set up, or the standard server provided by your CMS vendor. In both cases, setting up a firewall is not only good, it is essential.



A typical WAF layout

A web application firewall (WAF) is a server plugin or a physical device that sits in between all incoming traffic and your server. Its most basic job is to monitor all the traffic that tries to reach your server. There is a certain set of rules that each WAF follows to allow or block traffic at the check-point. It is especially good with HTTP traffic and can detect XSS (Cross-site scripting) and SQL injection attacks quite well and can also be configured to deal with additional, more sophisticated types of attacks. As we said earlier, this can be deployed at both the physical as well as online level. There are quite a few vendors with competitive offerings, and we suggest you check Amazon's AWS offering.

Check file extensions

This might feel insignificant until you understand the true possibilities. If your website allows files to be uploaded, then there is most probably a way to use that process to gain control of your backend. For example, if your website requires the user to upload an image (for profile pictures, document verification etc) and renames the file using the user ID, then the user